

10.1 Hosting Your Own Site

Once you're all done designing your site—whether it's HTML-based or runs off of a complete content management system—it's time to let the world see it. Very few of us have broadband-enabled servers or computers that are always-on, so you're probably not going to be able to run the site off your own computer. A lot of us want to be able to, however, so let's first look at what we need in order to be able to host our own sites on our PCs.

10.1.1 What you need

In order to host your own site, you will need to have a computer with a decent configuration, decide on a suitable operating system, Web server software and, of course, a broadband pipe that has at least 256 kilobits per second upload speeds—anything slower and your site is going to



Run a bandwidth test to check your connection speeds

crawl! Most ISPs in India are offering 256 Kbps connections, but this is the maximum download speed you will get, not the upload speed. You can either ask your ISP what the cap on your upload speeds is, or just run one of the many bandwidth tests we will talk about a little later on. For now, you can go to www.bandwidth-place.com and run their speed test.

We have come across instances where ISPs only put a cap on your download speeds and leave the upload speeds open as per usage. What this means is that although some of you might have a speed cap of 256 kbps in terms of downloads, you might find that your uploads are unrestricted. Don't count on this happening, though: most ISPs restrict both upload and download speeds, and in fact, you are more likely to find that your upload speeds are limited to 128 or even 64 Kbps!